

Ruth Cohen

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Education

University of Wisconsin - Madison

PhD in Economics & Finance

2023 - Present

MS in Economics

December 2025

Fields: Household Finance, Public Economics

Kenyon College

2016 - 2020

BA in Economics, *summa cum laude*, *High Honors*, *Distinction*

Minor in Mathematics, Concentration in Public Policy

Valedictorian, Phi Beta Kappa, GPA: 4.0

Thesis: [The Cross Price Elasticity of Demand between Soft Drinks and Seltzer Water Over Time](#), published in *The Developing Economist* Vol VII (UT-Austin Undergraduate Research Journal)

University of Oxford

2018 - 2019

Visiting Student in Economics & Mathematics

Overall grade: A

Research Experience

Wisconsin School of Business

Fall 2025

Research Assistant

Madison, WI

- Collaborate with Assistant Professor of Finance [Erik Mayer](#) on household finance research.
- Clean and analyze large datasets, including tradeline-level credit panel, HMDA, and CoreLogic Mortgage.

Federal Reserve Bank of Boston

2020-2023

Research Assistant, Senior

Boston, MA

- Assist Principal Economist and Policy Advisor [Joanna Stavins](#) with research on consumer finance, payments.
- Perform econometric analysis on survey, credit bureau, and supervisory credit card account data.
- Contribute to the production and dissemination of the Survey and Diary of Consumer Payment Choice.

Selected Projects

Dying with Debt: Asymmetric Information in the Parent PLUS Loan Program

with Swati Joshi

In progress

Documents borrower creditworthiness and repayment behavior across public and private parent loan markets and develops a model of moral hazard in the Parent PLUS loan program to assess how proposed borrowing caps may affect government revenue.

[Regulatory Relief and Small Bank Mortgage Lending](#)

Draft Available

The easing of CFPB enforcement actions under new leadership in 2018 had a greater impact on the availability of non-qualified mortgage lending than a similarly-timed policy targeted at the non-qualified mortgage lending of small banks (total assets below \$10b). I provide suggestive evidence that this is due to lower sophistication and policy attentiveness of small banks and a greater reliance on “rules of thumb” in their lending practice.

[Payments Evolution from Paper to Electronic Payments by Merchant Type](#)

with Oz Shy & Joanna Stavins

Federal Reserve Bank of Boston Research Department Working Paper 22-6

Analyzes changes in payment-method use from 2017 to 2020 across different merchant types using data from the Diary of Consumer Payment Choice.

Awards & Honors

Graduate Research Fellow, <i>Institute for Research on Poverty</i>	2025 - 2026
Wisconsin School of Business RA Fellowship Award	Fall 2025
Juli Plant Grainger Institute Teaching Excellence Award	Spring 2025
UW-Madison Economics Department Graduate Assistantship	2024 - 2025
Wisconsin School of Business Finance Department Summer Fellowship	Summer 2024, 2025
UW-Madison Economics Department Scholarship	2023 - 2026
UW-Madison Finance Department Fellowship	2023 - 2024
Duke Economics Pre-Graduate Fellowship	2022
First Place Paper, <i>Bowling Green State University Undergrad Econ Paper Contest</i>	2021
Paul Titus Award, <i>Kenyon College Economics Department</i>	2020
Valedictorian, <i>Kenyon College Class of 2020</i>	2020
Phi Beta Kappa (Junior inductee)	2019
Pi Mu Epsilon	2018
Head/Kirwan Scholarship	2017 - 2020
Kenyon College Promise Scholarship	2016 - 2020
Kenyon College National Merit Award	2016 - 2020
Minnesota JCC Marvelous Education Fund Scholarship	2016

Teaching

UW-Madison

<i>Teaching Assistant</i> , FIN305: Financial Markets, Institutions & Economic Activity	Spring 2026
<i>Teaching Assistant</i> , ECON101: Principles of Microeconomics	Fall 2024, Spring 2025
<i>Grader</i> , ECON714: Macroeconomic Theory (PhD)	Spring 2025
<i>Grader</i> , ECON530: Insuring Life's Risks	Spring 2025

Leadership & Service

Wisconsin Economics Graduate Organization, <i>President</i>	2025 - 2026
UW-Madison Economics Department, <i>Student Mentor</i>	2024 - 2026
UW-Madison Economics Department, Early Year Student Panel, <i>Panelist</i>	2025
UW-Madison Economics Department, <i>Social Chair</i>	2024 - 2025
Princeton University Bendheim Center for Finance, <i>Finance Summer School</i>	Summer 2024
Federal Reserve Bank of Boston, <i>Community College Pipeline Program</i>	2023
Federal Reserve Board, Exploring Careers in Economics, <i>Panelist</i>	2022
Federal Reserve Bank of Boston, <i>High School Speaker Series</i>	2022 - 2023
Tutoring Plus of Cambridge, MA, <i>Tutor</i>	2021 - 2022
Kenyon College Economics Department Reading Group	2019 - 2020

Programming

Stata, Julia, SQL, Python

Other Work Experience

City Engineer of Mount Vernon	2019 - 2020
<i>Data Analytics Intern</i>	<i>Mount Vernon, OH</i>
Kenyon College Library and Information Services	2017 - 2020
<i>Circulation</i>	<i>Gambier, OH</i>
Mid-Minnesota Legal Aid	Summer 2019
<i>Data Management Intern</i>	<i>Minneapolis, MN</i>
US Bank	Summer 2018
<i>Payments Risk Management and Compliance Intern</i>	<i>Minneapolis, MN</i>